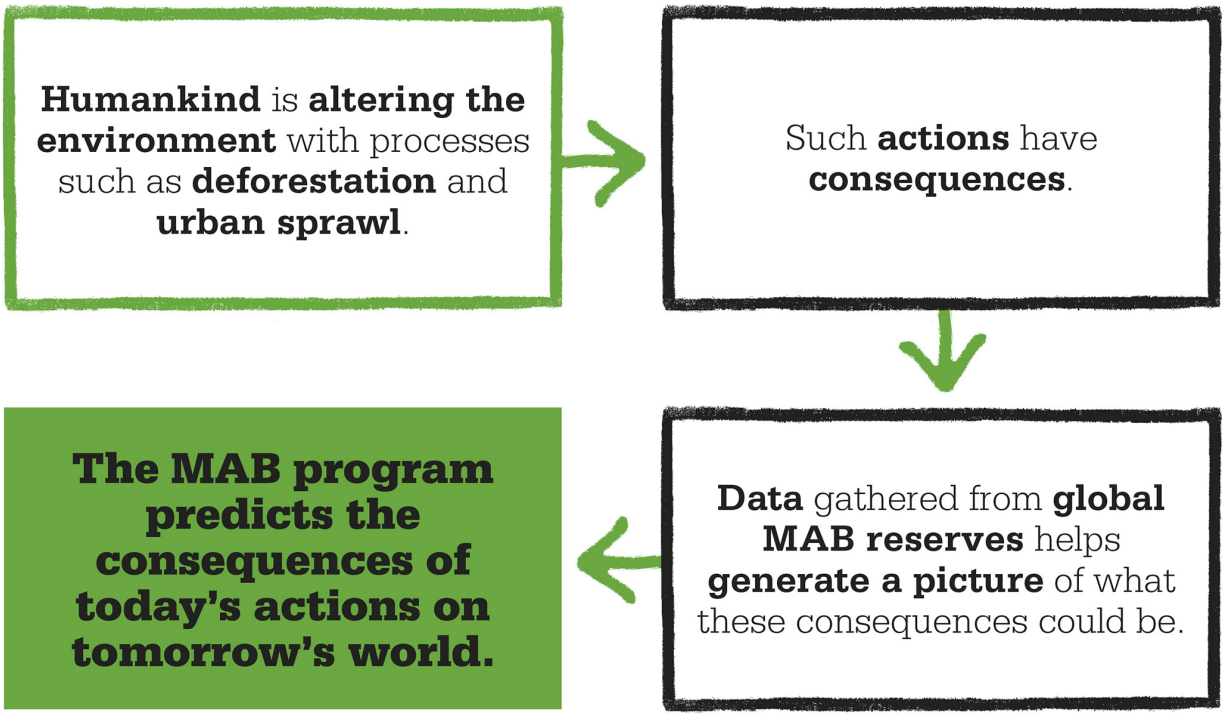
During the second half of the 20th century, there was an increasing global awareness of the importance of the relationship between humans and the natural world. This led, in 1971, to the United Nations Educational, Scientific, and Cultural Organization (UNESCO) launching the Man and the Biosphere Program (MAB). This is an intergovernmental program devoted to encouraging environmentally sustainable and equitable economic development, while protecting natural ecosystems.

UNESCO was founded after World War II with the aim of fostering "the building of peace, the eradication of poverty, sustainable development and intercultural dialogue through education, the sciences, culture, communication and information." As such, it was in a unique position to examine carefully the relationship between people and the environment.



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